ISSUE No.22 SEPTEMBER 1996

Thamesmead TIMES

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PUB OF THE MONTH
YOUR CHANCE TO VOTE FOR YOUR LOCAL - SEE PAGE 6

LEWIS COACHE
XMAS SHOPPING C
THE CONTINENT
SEE PAGE 10

M.A.S.H. Comes to Thamesmead



Gangs of young people took over part of the undeveloped land near the river during the Summer. The Thamesmead Adventure Scheme took place for the seventh consecutive year during the holidays.

Imagine the film set of M.A.S.H. Remember all the activity, all the noise as portrayed on screen, well that's how the Thamesmead Adventure Scheme was described to me. It's location was ideal, far away from all the houses, so those taking part could feel free to enjoy the scheme to their utmost.

Full Story Page 8

Thamesmead Tov Tenth Annual Genera Meeting

Wednesday 2nd October 1996 7.30pm at Thamesmead Community Colleg Yarnton Way

Several Exhibitions wi be on display at the college including the Improvements/New facilities for Constituen areas; Youth Scholarsh Scheme; Internationa Land Regeneration Expo

There will be the usua business of the AGM including the approval accounts and the electi of the Vice Chairman followed by an interva with refreshments.

Officers of the compar will make presantation giving information on what the company ha been involved in and future plans.

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NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS • NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS

Greenwich women are being encouraged to get involved. In February the Council called for women volunteers to help set up a new women's organisation to represent womens' views and provide advice services. Over 40 women answered the call and are now investigating setting up an organisation. The Council has recruited two development officers, Cauline Brathwaite and Louisa Goldstein-Thompson who are based at the Women's Centre, 45 Hare Street, Woolwich. A Forum meeting is scheduled for September 24, at 45 Hare Street, Woolwich, between 1.30 and 3.30 and 7pm and 9pm, creche places can be reserved. For further information contact Cauline or Louisa on 0181 317 8885.

Time to get fit. A new state of the art fitness centre opened earlier this month at the Arches Leisure Centre, Greenwich. The new centre, Millennium is designed with the most up to date training equipment. It is divided into four areas, The Cardio Theatre, The Resistance Arena, The Raceline Room and the 2000 room. Each is dedicated to focus on certain aspects of getting fit. Professional instructors are always available, phone 0181 317 5000 ext 2000 to arrange an appointment.

New scheme to boost local employment Greenwich Local Labour in Construction (GLLiC) supported by Greenwich Council, the Employment Service, training organisations and trade unions is setting up a database with information on local building and construction related companies in the borough. This information will be used to identify local companies who wish to tender for work and will be passed to the major contractors. Those interested in being included should contact Lucy Dowsett on 0181 317 6938. GLLiC is also drawing up a register of local people who are looking to work in construction, both those with skills and those seeking training. Further information from the GLLiC on 0181 317 6938.

Modern apprenticeships with Greenwich direct services. Greenwich Direct Services, the direct labour organisation of the London Borough of Greenwich are the first to announce the introduction of new modern apprenticeships in September. Seven locals embarked on the three year apprenticeship on September 2. There were over 100 applications, 35 were interviewed and the seven who won the places are Mark Herne, Lee Virgo, Sam Tramtham, David Atkins, Micheal Rock, Peter Baptiste, and the only female Toni Guest. They are aged between 16 and 20. The apprenticeship must be completed by the age of 23. The positions are divided between plumbing, painting, metal fabrication and electrical installations. The seven will learn skills on the job and will get training based on NVQ's up to level three.

Station gets green light Soon Greenwich Council, Docklands Light Rail Ltd., the preferred bidder for the concession to build the DLR Lewisham extension and other partners will agree to build the Cutty Sark Station. The station and extension will serve the travel needs of local people, businesses and tourists. The DLR extension pass through Greenwich, Depford Bridge and end at Lewisham Junction Station.

Passenger safety Security improvements will be unveiled at Plumstead station by Glenda Jackson MP, Shadow Minister for Transport in London, on September 23. Plumstead is the flagship station to date with a refurbished ticket hall, new entrance onto Plumstead Road, CCTV surveillance and work to seal off recessed areas that were attracting vandalism. The revamp is the latest stage in a programme to improve passenger security at the 11 railway stations in the borough of Greenwich. Other schemes completed so far include the ticket office at Woolwich Dockyard refurbished and reopened.

Bexley Council An exhibition marking the centenary of the death of Bexley's most famous resident, William Morris will be held at Hall Place, Bexley between September 7 and 29. William Morris was a noted author, designer, artist and poet who lived at Red House, Bexleyheath. Many examples of his work will be on display.

The Visual Arts Group of the Arts Council of Bexley invite entries to their 26 Open Art Exhibition which will be held in the North East Wing, Hall Place, Bourne Road, Bexley from November 9 to December 7. Entry forms and further details from Suzanne Knowles on 0181 309 5977.

• NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS • NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS •

FOCUS on contract news





New door entry systems including security doors and controlled building access. external view of completed door entry system at Keynes Court. finished security systems at Webb Court.



A view of Coraline Walk, showing two floors with new windows.



Holstein Way, roof treatment underway.



Webb Court with external redecoration completed.

THAMESMEAD TIMES
IS PUBLISHED BY
THAMESMEAD TOWN
HARROW MANOR WAY
THAMESMEAD SOUTH
LONDON
SE2 9XH

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SECOND CONSTITUENCY MEETING FOR MANORWAY RESIDENTS

Thamesmead has arranged the second constituency meeting for Manorway residents on Wednesday, 16 October 1996 at 12 noon at the Manorway Community Hall, Manor Close, Thamesmead North as part of the consultation process for improvements in their area. The centre will be open from 11am in order for residents to view a small exhibition showing improvements initiated in the Manorway area and other proposed schemes. There will also be a small exhibition on the youth scholarship scheme which has been introduced throughout Thamesmead. Refreshments will be available free of charge before the meeting.

The housing desk will be open from 11am. This will allow residents with individual problems to speak to a housing officer in person. Individual issues will not be allowed at the main meeting. If you have any suggestions for inclusion in the menu of proposed improvements, please ring the Directors Support Unit on 0181-310-1500 ext. 392. The deadline for receipt of items for the agenda is 26 September 1996.

The meeting will be chaired by Mr Gerry Bright, Director for Manorway.

This meeting is part of an ongoing consultation process with residents. The Company wishes to involve as many residents as possible.

SECOND CONSTITUENCY MEETING FOR SOUTHMERE RESIDENTS

Thamesmead has arranged the second constituency meeting for Southmere residents on Monday, 28 October 1996 at 7pm at Southlake Primary School, Seacourt Road, Thamesmead South as part of the consultation process for improvements in their area.

The School will be open from 6pm in order for residents to view a small exhibition showing improvements initiated in the Southmere area and other proposed schemes. There will also be a small exhibition on the youth scholarship scheme which has been introduced throughout Thamesmead. Refreshments will be available free of charge before the meeting.

The housing desk will be open from 6pm. This will allow residents with individual problems to speak to a housing officer in person. Individual issues will not be allowed at the main meeting. If you have any suggestions for inclusion in the menu of proposed improvements, please ring the Directors Support Unit on 0181-310 1500 ext. 392. The deadline for receipt of items for the agenda is 11 October 1996.

The meeting will be chaired by Mr Charan Gill, Director for Southmere.

This meeting is part of an ongoing consultation process with residents. The Company wishes to involve as many residents as possible.

Thamesmead Town Directors Surgeries

Broadwaters (Area 1)
Ray Hutchins;
Broadwaters Village Hall.
2nd Saturday of every month
11 am - 12 noon
Telephone: 0181 333 2001

Waterfield (Area 2)
David Irons;
33 Waterfield Close (Home),
Every Monday evening
7.15 pm - 9.15 pm.
Telephone: 0181 311 7761

Moorings (Area 3)
Ian Savill; Jubilee Centre,
Lytton Strachey Path.
Alternate Thursday
Evenings 7pm - 8pm.
(11th, 25th July; 8, 22nd Aug etc.)

Manorway (Area 4)
Gerry Bright; 33 Linnet Close,
Thamesmead North (Home).
Telephone: 0181 311 1946

Crossway (Area 5)
Albert Devereux;
7 Longworth Close (Home).
Daily 9am - 8pm,
Telephone: 0181 244 9323

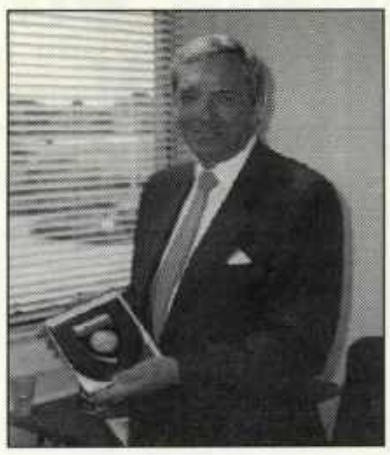
Southmere (Area 6)
Charan Gill is on holiday from the 25th August and will be returning by the 6th October. If you have any queries in his absence, please direct them to the Directors Support Unit at the Thamesmead Town offices in Harrow Manor Way. Telephone 0181 310 1500.

Lesnes (Area 7)
Tina Anderson;
Evenlode House Patch Office
1st Saturday of the month
10am - 11am

Parkview (Area 8)
Katharine Galloway;
32 a/b Maran Way,
Telephone 0181 333 1786.
1st Saturday of the month
10.30am - 12.30pm

Greenmead (Area 9)
David Shanks;
Greenmead Clubroom Lime Row,
1st Saturday each month
9am - 10am
Telephone: 0181 312 1371
(Before 9.45am)

Derek Crofton Retires



On Friday, 30th August Derek Crofton held a reception to say goodbye to the staff that he has worked alongside during his 8 years with the Company.

The Company were delighted to take this opportunity to present him with a number of gifts and to express their thanks for his commitment and work which have helped Thamesmead to grow, developing a strong financial strategy and with the Board, create a workable vision for the future of the Town.

Charles Teideman, the new Finance Director led the proceedings with a short speech, presenting a trophy, a cut glass rose bowl and a tape recorder to use in the new chapter of his life as a student. Derek has been awarded a place by the London School of Economics on an MSc course starting in October, he said 'I then hope to move into the Voluntary Sector where I shall endeavour to be of some use to the community.'

We know you will be a success Derek, it was great working with you and we all wish you all the best!

STOLEN VEHICLES RECOVERED

The first week of September saw Thamesmead Town's Security Coordinator earning his title well and truly.

On the Thursday morning a message was left with Thamesmead Town that a car had been abandoned in a garage in Tavey Bridge. The garage was immediately inspected and the car reported to the police. Police reported that the car had been stolen. The car was removed from the garage and placed in a secure area.

Later the same day, a motor b was reported in the canal at back of Manor Green. Anot motor bike, in good condition, discovered on the undeveloped la One of the dog handlers patroll the land found the motor bike sto away in a derelict building. seemed likely that it was left th for later collection.

The police confirmed that b these motor bikes had been sto They were placed in a secure are Both the motor bikes were clair by their owners within a day.

OFF THE ROAD CHARITY EVENT

An unusual event took place at Thamesmead on Sunday, September 8. Helen Jones and her Off Road London company hosted a charity event for two groups of disabled children aged between seven and 15 years old.

DAY OUT

The children from Miles of Smiles from Canterbury, and ELIFAR (every life is for a reason), from Hampshire, 'Thoroughly enjoyed themselves,' Helen told me. 'Safety was very important, at least one carer plus the driver went with each kid as they went out on the off road course.'

The Sunday was a day out for both the children and the carers. During the morning they enjoyed the off road experience. Then they took a break for lunch, a McDonalds, supplied at a reduced rate by McDonalds, Woolwich.

This was the first time Off Road London hosted such a day, Helen would like it to become an annual event. One of the groups were recommended by their drivers. The idea came about when Helen realised how much her own three children enjoyed the off road drives. Helen's children, aged eight, ten and eleven often join her off roading so she knew it was safe and fun for the young. She organised it 'As a way of helping others.'

ACTION

The afternoon was action packed, Plumstead Fire Station brought a fire engine for the kids to explore, Thamesmead Police brought a car, and local man, Peter Morgan brought a Bedford lorry! Peter plans to go on safari later this year, so he packed the lorry with all the requirements for an African safarl.

AND THE ANIMALS JOINED IN TOO!

Jenny Tuckfield brought along her border collies and gave a dog agility display. All the dogs are well trained and used to being handled by kids of all ages. Some of the kids joined Jenny in the arena helping her handle the dogs. Other children that were unable to join in were allowed to sit on the dogs backs so they didn't feel left out.

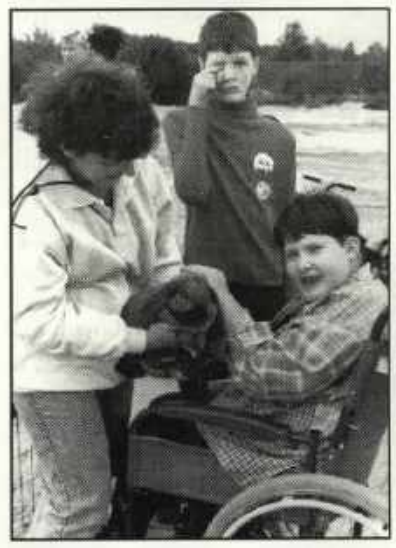
Thamesmead Animal Warden, Jane Alexander kindly brought her cuddle pets for the children to hug and play with. The day was full of interaction and new experiences for the kids.

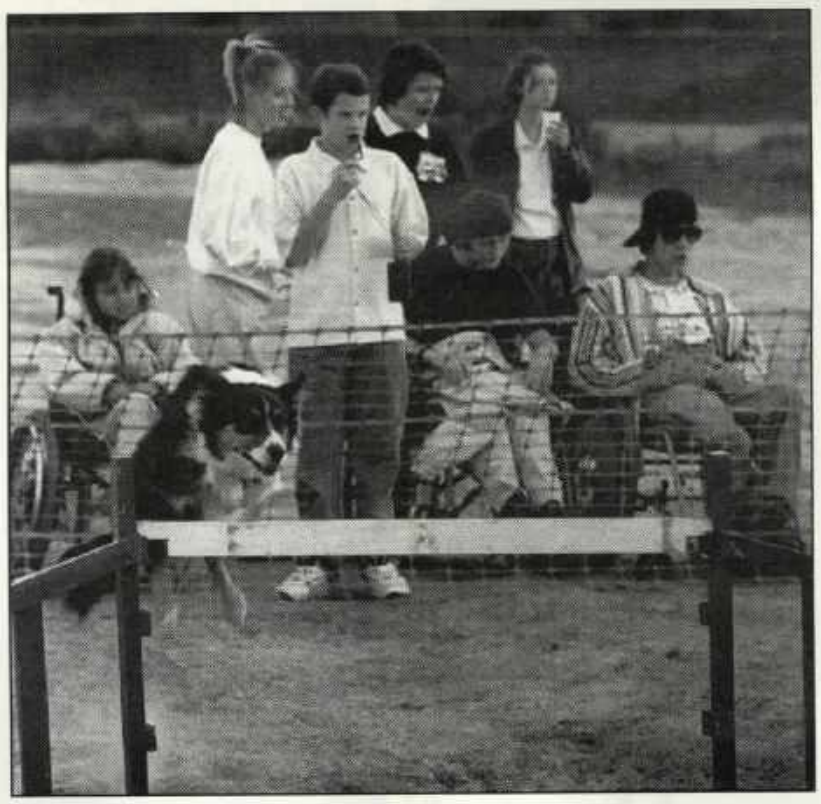
While the children were enjoying the arranged activities, the off road course was open to the public. Each user donated £10 to charity.

The proceeds of the day were divided between both groups, each getting £75. The 4x4 club, Range Rover Register's appointed charity The Cot Death Appeal received £45. When the children left to go home they each received a 'goody bag'. It was a profitable and enjoyable day for everyone who took part.

Off Road London would like to thank everyone who made the day possible, especially Thamesmead Town who gave the use of the land for the day.

To contact Off Road London, phone 0181 265 3760, and let Helen Jones enthusiasm rub off on you, 'We thoroughly enjoy it as a sport and it enhances your skills as an on road driver.'







COPY DEADLINES

Anyone wishing to submit copy for the next issue of Thamesmead Times, the deadline is Friday, October 4. Please forward all letters, stories and pictures to: The Editor, Thamesmead Times, Company Offices, Harrow Manor Way, on or before October 4 to ensure inclusion in the October issue.

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COMMUNITY NEWS

Putting the pieces together

The Tenant Participation Advisory Service (TPAS) held their eighth annual conference in Birmingham at the beginning of August.

The two day conference attracted 600 tenant delegates including our own Tina Anderson, Kathy Galloway and Ian Saville. Thamesmead Town were keen to be involved as it was the first conference with an attendance from the Company.

Delegates were welcomed by Chair of Housing in Birmingham, Councillor Marje Bridle who described their work to improve housing conditions in the city. The opening speech by Marianne Hood, TPAS Director, emphasised the importance of tenants working together and a real sharing of power. She drew attention to the Tenant Participation Charter that emphasises what tenant participation is about, 'An equal relationship based on the full participation of tenants in all matters affecting their homes and environment at all levels.'

From Westminster, MP's Nick Raynsford and Diana Maddock gave their view of how the pieces should be put together and answered tenants' questions about the organisation and funding of housing.

One full day of the conference was given over to workshops covering such topics as local housing companies, the future of housing associations, tenants and managing estates, and new funding for tenant training.

Nick Raynsford, Shadow Minister for Housing spoke about the House of Commons Environment Committee's report highlighting the extent to which current output of housing for social needs was falling below the level that would meet present needs. He then went on to discuss what his own party's thinking on housing is, 'It is essential to explore creative new ways of raising private finance for investment in public/private housing partnerships.'

'We are looking actively at a number of models to make this possible. The local housing company is one such model. Our view is that such companies could make a significant contribution towards meeting housing needs, not as an alternative to council housing, but as an additional weapon in the armoury.'

He backed active involvement by tenants and saw that every area is different and has different needs, 'Tenant participation is not something which can be determined by rigid formulae or fixed percentages. It is important that it develops from practical processes and that arrangements are tailored to meet the specific needs of individual localities.'

Our representatives from Thamesmead found the conference of great value, Kathy Galloway said 'This was an excellent opportunity for tenant representatives to share information and problems. Just by talking with other representatives from both councils and companies who are involved in the sort of voluntary work that we are, about the ideas they they have put into operation and how they handle their problems helps us all in our work in preparing the way forward for the future.'

Thamesmead Town is committed to community participation and the regular dialogue in constituency meetings plays a major role in evolving, as Marianne Hood said 'An equal relationship based on full participation by tenants in all matters affecting their homes and environment at all levels.'

SAMARITANS

LEWISHAM, GREENWICH & SOUTHWARK BRANCH

The Samaritans local branch needs new volunteers to befriend people on the telephone in times of crises. Two open days were held for the public to find out more about what the Samaritans do.

Anybody can be a volunteer!!

AT THE BLACKHEATH FRIENDS MEETING HOUSE.

LAWN TERRACE,

BLACKHEATH AT THE ART & CRAFT MARKET

GREENWICH MARKET SEl.

Though the response was good new volunteers are always welcome.

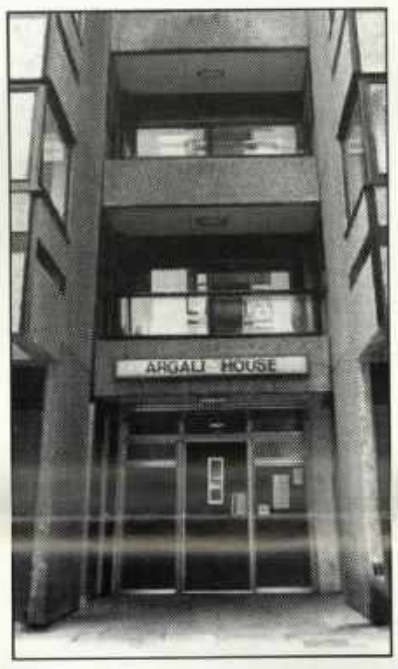
For further details contact: 0181 692 5228
ANYBODY CAN BE A VOLUNTEER!

Residents Meetings

Wren Path held a Residents Consultation Meeting on August 21. Door entry security proposals were discussed.



On August 27, and September 10 presentations were held about improvements to Argali House. Head of Housing and Technical Services, Graham Lilley met with residents to discuss changes needed to the building, and explain developments in progress. Internal improvements will include new bathrooms and new kitchens. External improvements being considered are security doors and redecoration.





Thamesmead
Working with the Community

Harrow Manor Way,
Thamesmead South,
London SE2 9XH.
Tel: 0181–310 1500
Fax: 0181–310 1811

MURAL MAGIC ON YARNTON WAY



If on a recent trip down Yarnton Way, you thought that you may have seen a queue of animals waiting at the bus stop, don't worry, your eyes haven't been deceivlng you!

The animals are the theme of a fantastic mural painted by local children aged between 5 and 11 as part of the Play Week organised by the Thamesmead Family Services Unit, who are a voluntary social services group.

For the second year running the unit has taken a week out from its normal work and run a week of activities for the children. The has also included a picnic, a treasure hunt, cookery, pantomime, arts & crafts, football and gardening at t Emmanuel Church Garden.

Funding for the Play Week ca from Thamesmead, who donat £150 for the mural, and from t Greenwich Play Associatic Thamesbank Insurance and soc services.

Vandalism

Sadly the mural has alrea been vandalised, despite the use apparently anti-graffiti paint. T children worked hard on this mu to make Thamesmead a bright a cheerful place – don't undo all th hard work. If children as young five care about how their envir ment looks, it should be an exam to us all.



ADVENTURE SPORTS

A new school year has just started; sadly it signals the end of another summer at Southmere Adventure Playground.



On Friday, August 30 the Adventure Playground hosted its own sports day. John Johnson, acting adventure playground supervisor called it, "The finale to the six weeks holiday." Not only did the children have a lively sports day to round off the holiday, they also had a free buffet to keep their energy levels topped up. The casual staff, Janet Butler, Sue Masters, Richard Krabbendam, Wayne Miles and Trevor Cross along with John Johnson catered to the little adventurers.

During the summer holidays the playground is open from noon to 5pm, in school term the playground only opens at weekends. The casual staff keep the amenity going, working as and when they can.

The playground is for eight to 16 year olds. A colourful bouncy castle provides the centre of amusement; other facilities include rope swings and an aerial runway. Regular barb-ques are organised on site, as well as day trips either to the cinema or local leisure centre. Once children join the adventure playground, for a nominal fee of 20p they are life members.You can see from the smiling faces in the accompanying pictures that it's a happy and healthy way for the youth of Southmere to spend their time.





MP Applauds Thamesmead Adventure Scheme

The Southmere Swan hosted this Summers Thamesmead Adventure Scheme prize giving. Local MP John Austin-Walker, the Mayor of Bexley, Councillor Ron Brierly and the Metropolitan Police Commissioner, Ian Johnston presented the prizes.

Outstanding Commitment was won by Graham Perrin. Graham has been with the scheme since the beginning, first as an Adventurer and as now a Leader. Team of the Scheme was won by a team with a disabled member. The self-discipline and team spiritedness shown by the whole team earned them the special recognition.

FIRST CLASS SCHEME

John Austin-Walker told the young people and parents at the prize giving that, "This is a first class scheme helping young people to build confidence, learn about team working, co-operation and self discipline. It is also an excellent example of the Police working with the community, youth workers and the local authorities."

He went on to praise the helpers and volunteers, "These volunteers represent what is best in Thamesmead. They give up their leisure time to help others. A graphic example of the scheme's success is that a number of young people who have been on the scheme in previous years return when they are older as volunteer leaders."

SOLOTEC

Helping people to reach their full potential

What is SOLOTEC? SOLOTEC is the Training and Enterprise Council for South London. Their main aims are to develop a workforce with relevant skills and ultimately improve the South London economy.

SOLOTEC are hosting: Business Forum SOLOTEC Head Office, 7 Elmfield Road, Bromley - Tuesday, 1st October, 7 - 9 p.m.. Greenwich, Trafalgar Tavern, 7 - 9p.m., Wednesday, 9th October.

A Training for Work Open Day: Woolwich, 33/35 Spray Road, 10 - 4 pm, Friday, September 27.

For more information ring SOLOTEC's Customer Services Team on 0181 313 9232.

Do you have a story to tell?

The Thamesmead Times would like to hear about you, your family and friends

Have you or someone you know had a sporting achievement and overcome obstacles to get there? Perhaps you want to tell readers about the love of your life, or perhaps your club or association has done something successful, exciting or funny.

We've all got those co-incidences or funny experiences to share-why not share them with the readers of the

Thamesmead Times.

PRIZES TO BE WON

If your story gets published you can win a Bouquet of flowers from the Little Flower Shop in Thamesmead Town Centre or a subscription to your favourite magazine at the Front Page Newsagents

(worth £15).

Why not put pen to paper NOW!

Mystry Trip Lucky Winners

The winners of 20 pairs of tickets on the Lewis Group Travel Le Shuttle mystery trip

Mrs. P. Clark	Mrs. A. Stratton
Mr. S. J. Cave	Jennifer Haskings
E. F. Robertson	Mrs. Pauline Maxwell
Mrs. F. Ryan	Mr. J. P. Ryan
Mrs. Anderson	P. W. and L. F. Roffey
Mr. and Mrs T. Hunt	D. Jeffery
Mrs. P. A. Cooney	Mrs. M. Appiah
Mr. R. Philip	Mrs. Lydia Riddle
Mrs. L. Bose	Nick Foulds
Mrs. A. Nicholson	Mrs. B. Lodge



LIGHTS, CAMERA, ACTION!

Bexley Council is inviting school children to capture the work of their local authority on film. A National Schools Video Competition, 'Council Business' is open to teams of students between the ages of 14 and 16, is in it's fifth year.

One of the aims of the competition is to raise the students' awareness of their future participation as voters.

The top prize is £2,000, closing dates for entries is December 31. The videos must be produced in English.

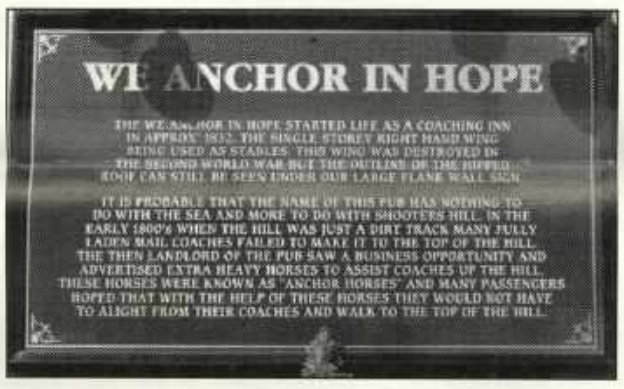
Further details from Brenda Parsons, 0181 303 7777 ext 4343 or Pat Batcup, 01582 451 166 ext 332.

The RTM/Thamesmead Times "Pub of the month"





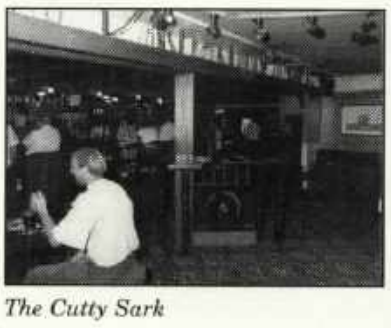
This months pub of the month, WE ANCHOR IN HOPE, Welling, has been around since 1832! A plaque on the front wall tells the whole story of the pub and how it got it's name, we thought it was so fascinating that we had to reproduce it for you here. When we went to tell the landlord of the pub that they had won, he was on holiday! Mark Peters, pictured right, and his wife Sara have been covering for Andy and Dawn McDonald in their absence. Andy and Dawn have been running We Anchor in Hope for a year now, and are reaping the rewards of their initiative and commitment. Congratulations Andy and Dawn for winning the RTM/Thamesmead Times pub of the month! The pub has just re-opened after a six week shut down for refurbishment. According to Mark, "The bar is now smaller, but the space is better utilised. The locals and regulars like it, more families come here now."As the pub is now keen to encourage families, it features kiddies meals and parties and of course a bouncy castle!



A FEW OF THE OTHER PUBS WE VISITED



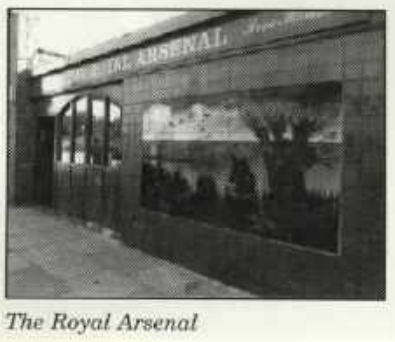
The Leather Bottle



The Cutty Sark



The Harrow Inn



The Royal Arsenal

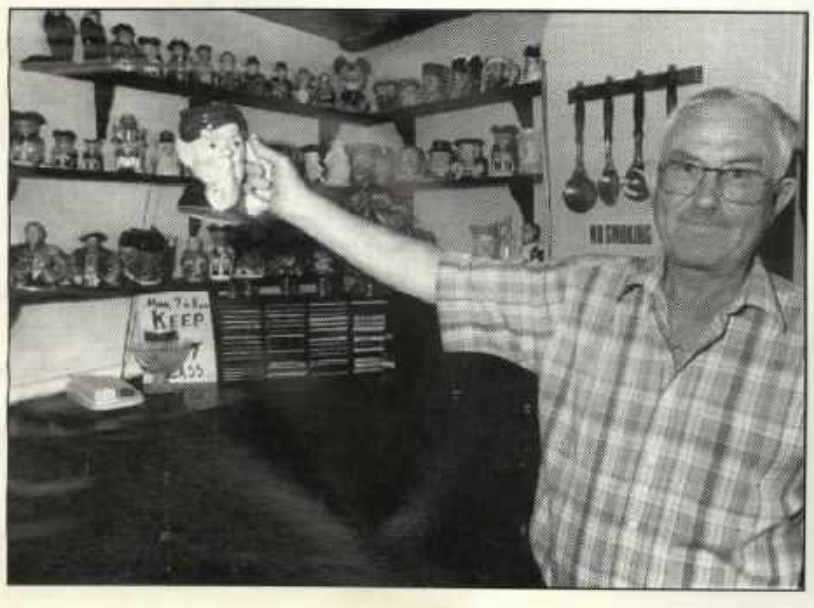
TIPS FROM THE PUB SPY!

I like a bit of character to my pubs, I don't mind if it's supplied by the atmosphere of the pub, the clientele or if it comes from behind the bar.

Usually it's best if those behind the bar know their place! You know what I mean, there to serve your every liquid want, with a smile of course. If you're feeling a bit down, they should immediately realise this and offer a friendly ear, or have a cheery joke to bring a laugh to your throat!

It's even better if you've managed to find a pub that offers excellent food as well, saves on the washing up at home!

Some of the pubs I spied on had lovely gardens, a pity it's turned so autumnal! One of them even had some caged birds to add to the ambience. That's what I like to see, a bit of imagination - what do you think of that splendid collection of tankards? And it's not even been going a year yet!



YOUR CHANCE TO VOTE FOR YOUR LOCAL PUB

Even if the pub spy missed you on his tour of inspection I'm sure you have an idea which pub pulls the coolest pints. Now we are giving you the customers a chance to vote for your favourite watering hole too!

RTM/THAMESMEAD TIMES PUB OF THE MONTH

Where in the Thamesmead area is the best pub?

_____

_____

_____

Why is it the best pub in town?

_____

_____

_____

_____

Please return to:

The 'Pub of the Month',
Thamesmead Times,
Harrow Manor Way,
Thamesmead South,
London SE2 9XH

ANNOUNCEMENT FOR PUBLICANS!

WIN A MONTHS FREE RADIO PROMOTION ON RTM
A FREE ADVERTISEMENT IN THE THAMESMEAD TIMES AND MORE!

Q: Do you think your pub is the best?
Q: Do you think your pub is the most fun?
Q: What do your regulars think about their local watering hole?

RTM/THAMESMEAD TIMES 'PUB OF THE MONTH'

We will be choosing a pub each month to win of lots of free promotion and the title of 'Pub of the Month'!

All you have to do is drop us a line telling us why you think your pub should be selected.

Each month Jon Lucas of RTM will select a short list, The Thamesmead Times will photograph the pubs on the short list with their publicans and we will then choose the winner for that month.

The 'Pub of the Month' will receive:

An engraved shield which will be replaced with a certificate at the end of their month

A month of free promotion on RTM

A free advertisement in the Thamesmead Times

A presentation will be organised which will also be covered by the Thamesmead Times

We want to see our post bags overflowing with responses, your customers now also have voting forms. We want to see some real competition here!

Send your entry to:

RTM/Thamesmead Times
'Pub of the Month'
Harrow Manor Way
Thamesmead South London
SE2 9XH
or fax: 0181 312 3589

Bronco's visit day centre



Ashley Day Centre, Woolwich enjoyed the company of the London Broncos Rugby League Team for a day at the end of August. The lucky ones in attendance at the day care centre on the day enjoyed a BBQ and then a game of rugby with the team. They gave out hats andt-shirts to participants and donated a signed rugby ball for fund raising.

HUNTER PLASTICS creating new jobs

Greenwich MP and Shadow Minster for Housing, Nick Raynsford (left), joins Hunter Plastics MD Chris Nunn (right) and Operations Director Steve Windsor at the site of Hunter Plastics new rapid distribution hub.



This month Hunter Plastics open a site in Woolwich. Woolwich Development Agency's business support programme helped the hub with an £80,000 grant. Hunter Plastics' Operations Director Steve Windsor said, 'It brings the potential to create new jobs over the next couple of years.'

LOCAL ARTIST

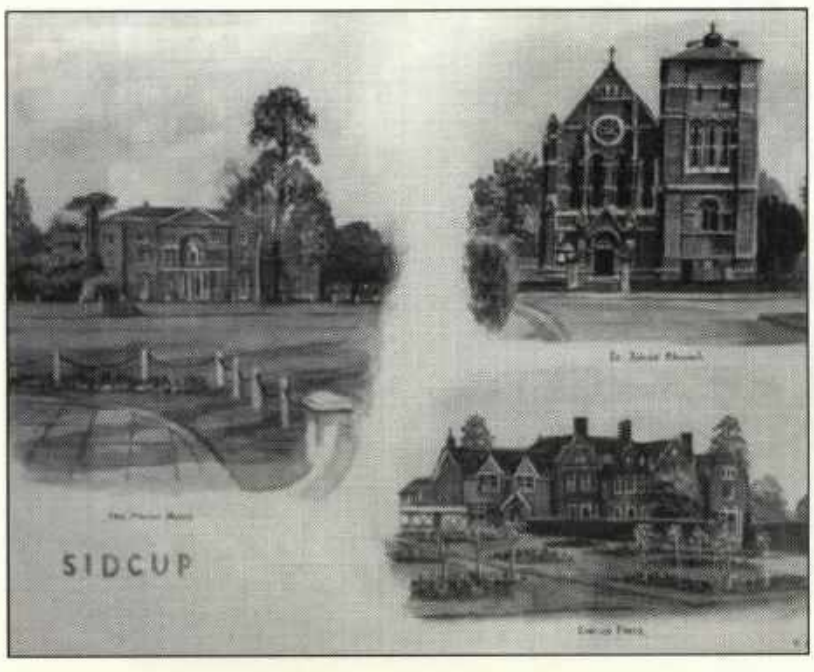


Ken Watkins, a Sidcup painter exhibits his work at Hall Place from August 31 to September 21.

Ken had to borrow back some of his works from their new owners to fill his One Person Art Programme at Hall Place. Many of his pieces are commissions and portraits. He paints both animals and people, but his favourite subjects are shire horses.He has been an artist most of his life. He considers himself self-taught, except when he took evening classes while serving in the RAF in Germany.

Now at the age of 58, Ken makes his living from his pictures and has to a large extent since 1970. Most of his work is sold locally, in Kent and Surrey and he somehow has tapped into the American market so though he does not sell outside of this country many of his paintings do go abroad.

Ken's other interests include walking and gardening. He uses his walks as research for his painting of landscapes and local scenes.



THAMESMEAD · SE28

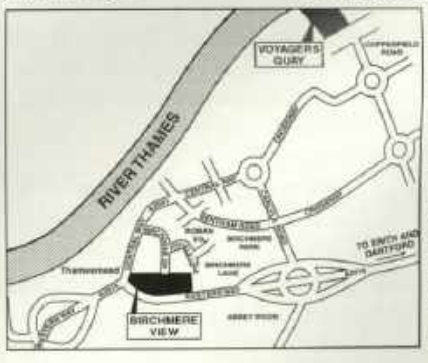
MOVE UP TO BARRATT WATERSIDE



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Move up to a better area in Thamesmead. Visit Barratt now.

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3 bedroom, 2 bathroom houses from **£87,995**.
2 bedroom riverside apartments from **£59,995**.
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Telephone: 0181 311 6979.



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http://www.ukpg.co.uk/barratt

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Thamesmead green fingers



Those of us who occupy houses built by the GLC were lucky enough to be allowed good garden space. Some others may be more limited in space, even only having window boxes, in spite of this you can do a lot with a garden, no matter what size.

Thamesmead was marshland before the houses were built and so has reasonably good soil, sometimes it's worth digging in a little lime as in some areas, it can be quite acidic.

Flowers or Vegetables

My front garden is about fifteen foot square. I reserve it for flowers and plants. I like to have a bit of colour at the front of my house.

Behind my house, I have a space about four times the size of the front garden. It does not seem all that big as I grow a good variety of crops, it is a beneficial vegetable garden. Once my swedes are dug up later in the year, I will be ready for seed potatoes and next month I will be planting a few spring cabbages.

I grow raspberry bushes along the back fence, apart from pruning they are not hard work. I also have some rhubarb, gooseberry bushes and a plum tree.

Greenhouse

I invested in a small greenhouse, though it is unheated. I plant tomatoes, cucumbers, and aubergines. I can also bring on seeds, ready to be planted out, when they are big enough to look after themselves.

My point is if you have the space, it's always handy to grow a some vegetables for your own table, and it always tastes that little bit nicer. Herbs are also easy to grow in the garden, or even a window box.

Although I am no expert, I like to see things grow and it's not difficult. Just keep a watering can handy in dry weather, be patient and don't be afraid to experiment.

Give your garden a go and see how easy it is. I'll be here to answer your queries and guide you through the maze of green fingers!

Dave Irons

BATTLE OF BRITAIN/AIRFIX WINNERS

Last issue we ran a Battle of Britain/Airfix model competition, the two lucky winners were:

Mrs D Lansdell
19 Bertrand Way
Thamesmead
SE28 8LL

Ms L Skingsley
13 Osney House
Hartslock Drive
South Thamesmead
SE2 9XA

Congratulations!! to the winners and commiserations to all those who entered the competition better luck next time.

rtm RADIO 103·8 FM

MONDAY–THURSDAY
06.00 JON LUCAS
10.00 RODNEY COLLINS
11.00 BARRY LEWIS
14.00 ANDY McCOLL
16.30 MARK FOX
19.30 SAMMY BELL

FRIDAYS
06.00 JON LUCAS
10.00 RODNEY COLLINS
11.00 BARRY LEWIS
15.00 MARK FOX
19.00 SPORT
19.30 SAMMY BELL
21.30 ANDY McCOLL
00.00 1/2 HOUR NEWS ROUND – UP
00.30 RTM CLASSIC GOLD
02.00 STARSOUND
04.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

SATURDAYS
06.00 BARRY LEWIS
10.00 MARK FOX
12.00 RAY BRADSHAW
15.00 BEAUTIFUL GAME
18.00 ANDY McCOLL
21.00 LOVE SONGS THROUGH THE NIGHT
00.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

SUNDAYS
06.00 WENDY SAUNDERS (INC. VIETNAMESE PROGRAMME)
08.00 RODNEY COLLINS
10.00 JON LUCAS
13.00 SAMMY BELL
14.00 DELROY HAYNES
18.00 SOUL SHOW
19.00 BEAUTIFULL GAME
21.00 JOHN KENNEDY–THE INDIE SHOW
00.30 NICK PARASKOU– THE CLUB SHOW
01.30 AYO BADEJO
03.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

EVENINGS ON RTM

MONDAYS
21.30 RICKSTER AND RAY BRADSHAW
00.00 STARSOUND BHANGRA
03.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

TUESDAYS
21.30 TONY ANDERSON
22.30 PETER HAYNES
00.30 YVONNE – GOSPEL SHOW
02.00 STARSOUND
04.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

WEDNESDAYS
21.30 ANDY McCOLL
00.30 RTM CLASSIC GOLD
02.00 STARSOUND
04.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

THURSDAYS
21.30 ANDY McCOLL
00.30 RTM CLASSIC GOLD
02.00 STARSOUND
04.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

FRIDAYS
21.30 ANDY McCOLL
00.30 RTM CLASSIC GOLD
02.00 STARSOUND
04.00 RTM CLASSIC GOLD

Gerry Bright's Holiday Tips

Greece

HAIKIDIKI NORTHERN GREECE



This is probably the most loved area of Greece and certainly very popular with the Brits.

Halkidiki is in the northern part of Greece with three peninsulas reaching into the beautiful Aegean Sea, giving a feeling of being on an island. Long sandy beaches lead from the sea into pine woods and olive groves and many areas are still unaffected by development.

We flew from Gatwick to Thessaloniki, and then spent just over an hour driving through the countryside to our hotel, Meliton Beach at a small resort, Porto Carras.

Sports facilities

The resort boasts a wonderful yachting marina and a wide range of sports facilities, including an 18 hole golf course, which I enjoyed playing. I did find it hard work though, the temperature was in the 90's, but the beer afterwards was cooler!

A regular water bus runs from the hotel to the busy and popular Neo Marmaras where we found numerous bars, tavernas and shops.

Few felt the need to leave the hotel more than once or twice as it had so many facilities and extensive gardens. We found the resort of a high class but not really suitable if you are on a limited budget.

Many people take a boat cruise to marvel at the monasteries of Mount Athos. Thessaloniki is also popular for the sights and the shops, it's large and bustles with visitors.

Quiet and relaxing

Personally, the plus points of the resort were the relaxed atmosphere, the space on the beach and gardens. There was no need to race the Germans for the sunbeds! The flip side of that is some people may think of it as an extremely quiet resort, but others would say this is a high point.

Wide range of prices

Our two week half-board holiday at this 4 star hotel cost £540 each but you can find taverna holidays for as little as £250.

I booked my holiday in Nuxley Road, Belvedere with Belvedere Travel and found the service excellent. Speak to Steve or Martin, they will work hard to find you the holiday you want, when you want it, at a price you can afford.

Adventure Scheme



Continued from page 1

The scheme has now been internationally recognised. There were ten European applications ranging from Portugal to Iceland resulting from an advertisement run in a European publication. The lucky groups that joined in were from Sweden and Luxembourg. The Swedish representatives were well prepared, they even went on a pre-camp session, before travelling here. This year saw another breakthrough in that it was the first time that wheelchair bound participants took part.

AIMS

The goals behind the scheme are to encourage teenagers and those approaching their teens to become more responsible, develop their team skills and develop an appreciation of those in authority.

It is aimed mainly at those in the Thamesmead and Abbeywood area. The Adventurers are drawn from the 10 to 16 age group. The Social Services and local homebeat officers refer boys and girls to attend. Word of mouth is another way that the Adventurers are recruited. As the scheme has been running for some time now, some of those that took part as Adventurers themselves in years gone by are now Leaders.

Each week a new influx arrived at the scheme, the first two days were non residential, the final two days were residential. Tents were pitched to provide accommodation.

ACTIVITIES

Activities ranged from archery to rock climbing, from lake exercises to night hikes. Most of the activities were based on site and supervised by volunteers. Two police officers Rick Beavis and Steve Henning were on hand all the time.

The scheme was the brainchild of PC Rick Beavis seven years ago. The fact that it is still running is a testament to the brilliance of the idea. PC Steve Henning first heard about it four years ago, now he is in Thamesmead he has been able to throw himself right into it. Steve believes, 'the scheme builds good community relationships and it now means that the kids talk to us.' (the police) 'As far as I know it's the only residential course of it's kind in the metropolitan area, it does seem to reduce the crime rate.

A grateful thank you to all those who helped make this Summer's scheme such a success.

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Avoid the Christmas rush and book your Christmas party now! If you go down to the Old Mill Hotel in Bexley and book your party before October 31 st everyone in your party will get a £50 holiday voucher.

We've also got together with Scottish & Newcastle's Old Mill Hotel to offer you the opportunity of winning a £100 voucher off your Christmas party when held at the restaurant during December.

At the Old Mill Hotel you can expect a Christmas menu offering the usual quality and value that customers have come to expect. As well as traditional Christmas fayre, there are plenty of ineresting dishes to choose from – Pork with a rich mustard sauce, Chicken Breast with a pepper and stilton sauce, Roast Beef, Salmon with a light lemon sauce and a Mushroom and Spinach Wellington for vegetarians.

So forget your post holiday blues, put your skates on and enter our competition. Just answer these simple questions.

1) What is another name for Father Christmas?

2) What do people do under the mistletoe?

3) What is the name of the red-nosed reindeer?

Please send your answers to The Editor, Thamesmead Times, Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH. CLOSING DATE: 1 4TH OCTOBER 1996

SCOTTISH & NEWCASTLE *hotels*

Plan for your Wedding with the experts



Visit the Grand Wedding Exhibition to be held in Thamesmead Community College on Sunday 20th October!

From cars, suits and dresses to horse and carriage, cakes, catering and marquees, DJs and entertainers, videos and stationery, flowers and sugared almond favours, hair and beauty - it will all be there.

Bring along your Mum, sisters and friends - and why not the guys too, admission is FREE, there is a FREE prize draw and FREE car parking too.

The Wedding Exhibition starts at 10am and runs through until 4pm.

Make your wedding a day to remember with the help of the professionals.

EXHIBITORS NOTE!

If you have not taken the opportunity to book your stand yet, there is still time.

This is the first time a Wedding Exhibition has been held in Thamesmead – so you are basically looking at an untapped market.

Allison Marie Catering who are co-ordinating the exhibition get lots of work from the Thamesmead area and can recommend this as an ideal venue to promote your services and develop your business.

These are some of the exhibitors already booked: Bomboniere by Gemelle, A. A. Executive, Mane Attraction, Snowdens, The Carriage Company, Allison Marie Catering, Jaquelines House of Brides, Kent Marquees, Nigel Barrett Photography and Stationery, Evergreen Florists, DJ Associates, The Burlington Quartet, Mike Ridley Video.

For further information of either visiting or exhibiting please telephone Allison Marie Catering on 0181 310 6573.

ARVAC Association for Research in the Voluntary and Community Sector announce their new address from October 1st: 60 Highbury Grove, London N5 2AG. Tel: 0171 704 2315

Drama, Arts and Crafts

Who out there has just finished, or is taking part in drama, art or craft classes? Wouldn't it be fun to have your efforts featured in your local paper? We are only interested to know what you are interested in and how you are doing, send us in pictures and either write your story or arrange for our reporter to meet you!

What's happening in Thamesmead?

Any events coming up that you would like your neighbours in Thamesmead to know about, tell us and we will include them in our new listings calendar

The Next Generation

Secondary school students from Lewisham and Greenwich are putting on an art show at the Woodlands Art Gallery, SE3.

The exhibition is intended as a showcase of the work done by pupils studying for GCSEs, GNVQs and 'A Levels. Their work reflects many of today's issues and includes sculptures and paintings.The show runs from September 14 to October 19, for further details phone, 0181 8585847.

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DATES

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Saturdays 9th and 23rd November 1996
Saturdays 7th and 14th December 1996

PICK-UP POINTS/TIMES

Broadwater Rd 07.00, Lintonmead school 07.10,
Bayliss Avenue 07.15, Boiler House 07.20,
Limestone Walk 07.25, Barge Pole 07.30,
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Thamesmead to Le Touquet "FANTASTIQUE"

Diary of a day trip to France by Anne Mancie

7.30am - threw packed lunch in my bag, checked both Louise, my son's girlfriend and I both had our passports, out of the back door and ran to the Boiler House. The Lewis coach was ready and waiting for us, 7.35 dead on time – great – neither of us were late.



Half full already and Louise and I were shown to our seats by Les, the driver. Bob McNab our Lewis representative, got on board and gave us all a 'Thamesmead Times' for our travel reading. Then we set off to Folkestone and Le Shuttle!

The tunnel was a new experience and I must admit I like to try new things, so I couldn't wait to see what was in store.

We reached Folkestone in no time. Bob told us about the 'Duty Free'. Being a first for us, Louise and I sauntered over to the building to have a wander round the shops, including Boots, Tie Rack, a toy shop and coffee shop as well as the Duty Free area, of course we bought some booze! Even though this wasn't what we came for I can understand the attraction, everything is just so cheap.

Back to the coach to catch the 10.20 train. We drive straight on, we're about seven compartments back, once we park, Bob suggests we stretch our legs. We took his advice, as did a few of the other passengers, which gave us the opportunity of chatting and getting to know each other a little. The journey itself was a breeze, 35 mins door to door, and we were in Calais before Bob had handed out the Belgian chocolates!

Forty minutes drive down the coast, we passed the well kept Military Cemetery, just outside Le Touquet, then drove through 'Millionaires Row', great houses, but expensive! Horrah! We've reached the sun drenched beach of Le Touquet.

Bob told us we have almost four hours to have a good look round. Louise and I found awarm patch of sand and enjoyed a tranquil moment.

It was nice to relax for half an hour after such an early start, and then we took a serious look round. There are lots of expensive shops, and being French they're that little bit different. We loved the pastries and the ice creams, nothing like French pastries to bring a smile to my face!

Before now, I had done the usual cross channel trips, Le Touquet is definitely more up market, cleaner and smarter. The French themselves promenading along the front from about mid afternoon. The Aqua Park was closed as it was the end of the French holiday season, but I think that was probably a bonus for us, although there were a few other tourists, Dutch, German and another two coaches from England.

4 o'clock and its time to leave the warm winds of Le Touquet. Next stop was shopping at Calais's Euro Market; it's big, and well worth a visit. Tescos, Etam, McDonalds, to name but a few. Sorry but we hadn't become complete Francophiles and we eat at McDonalds!

We were back on the coach at 6.30, and yes you guessed it, straight back to the Duty Free before the journey back on Le Shuttle and home. I liked the English duty free side better!

Well, it was dark and rainy when we finally arrived back on English roads. Les turned up the singalong tape and we all, well, those of us who remembered the words anyway, sang along to the music, to finish off a really great trip.

We got back to the Boiler House at about 10pm, and carrying my heavy case of Fosters, I was tired out, and spent out. It's amazing how much duty free you are allowed. Still I was glad to be home!

Bob and Les, looked after us all very well. I can't wait for the next trip! I now know I didn't take nearly enough money and I really do need to brush up on the words to 'OnMother Kelly's doorstep .., and what was it Bob, ..'Ah, Ah! or Oh Oh! Mysterious Girl!'

Man's Madness and Mayhem on stage

Larks Theatre Company came into being only this spring. Ian White and Joyce Harper set up the company, Woyzeck is their first ever production.

From September 10 to 28, Larks Theatre Company's Woyzech is playing at The Bird's Nest Theatre in Depford. Five actors play 12 characters in this production, but if anything this adds to the production.

Franz Woyzeck is played by a Welsh man, Gareth John. It is a little disconcerting seeing a German soldier being played by a Welsh man in South London! Franz's wife Marie is played by the only female actor in the production, Julie Walker.

To make the story more accessible to to days audiences it is possible to draw similarities between Marie's character here, and Tiffany's character in Eastenders! Marie is a spunky character, has a fresh faced appeal to the opposite sex and knows what makes he happy.

Franz is the long sufferin patient of a doctor who has per scribed him a diet of peas!! He ha to report regularly to the doctor wh uses him as a human guinea pig i his undisclosed experiments on th mind.

The relationships between Fran and the rest of the world is a sur fire recipe for explosion! As Woyzec runs until September 28 I would no like to ruin it for you.

A brief word of warning, ther are 20 scenes before all is revealed but not to worry, The Bird's Nes Theatre is cosy and upstairs in pub! I enjoyed my visit to Germa drama, this is probably due to th excellent translation to English b Paul Cooke, highlighting the blac humour in this tale of a man drive to madness!

Tickets available from £3.50, bo office: 0181 694 2255.

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We're holding a series of open days (see later adverts for dates). So why not visit us, be curious and see what we have to offer. Our doors are open to all, enquiries welcome from BSS, DSS and private.

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Tuesday 10th December
Brugge, Belguim £15.00 per person

Thursday 12th December
Tuesday 17th December
Thursday 19th December
Cité Europe Calais £12.00 per person

PICK-UP POINTS

Broadwater Rd 07.00, Lintonmead school 07.10,
Bayliss Avenue 07.15, Boiler House 07.20,
Limestone Walk 07.25, Barge Pole 07.30.
returning 19.30hrs (Calais) 21.00hrs (Brugge)

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THAMESMEAD Sport

Hopes fade for London Broncos

A mixed couple of weeks for the London Broncos began with the signing of Wigan hero, Martin Offiah, and ended with shattered play-off hopes after a surprise defeat against Paris St Germain.

The loss put an end to the Broncos' dream of a prize winning first season and summed up their inconsistency over the course of the season. A rejuvenated London side had re-established their challenge for a play-off position with impressive home victories over league leaders St Helens, Oldham and Warrington all watched by more than 5,000 spectators. The capture of Martin Offiah in the Super League's biggest transfer of the season, had only added to hopes of a late season rally.

However, a defeat against lowly Paris put an end to any lingering title thoughts. Cruelly, it was Danny Smith, sacked from London after missing several training sessions, who kicked the away side to victory.

Although this was a disappointing performance, the Broncos first season in the top flight has been a success. Attendances have been consistently high and the Valley has proved to be an excellent home. The future on the field looks good, and with the help of Offiah a top spot is not out of reach for the London side next season.

FIVE-A-SIDE

Thamesmead Town and Greenwich Youth Service have united to hold a Saturday five-a-side league during October. The competition will take place at Hawksmoor Youth Club. Teams from under 11's, to under 19's may enter and it is open to both boys teams and girls teams.Cost of entry is £2.00 per team. Further details from Arthur Blackman, Hawksmoor Youth Club, 0181 310 9754.

STEP AEROBICS AND KEEP-FIT SESSIONS HELD LOCALLY

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at the Thamesmead School of Dance and Fitness.
Disraeli Close, Thamesmead.
Admission £3.00

AEROBICS AND KEEP-FIT
Tuesday 7pm to 8pm
St Michaels Church Hall, Abbey Road. **Admission £2.50**

Thursdays 7.30pm to 8.30pm
The Church of the Cross Hall, Lensbury Way, Thamesmead
Admission £2.50

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0181 312 0993

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Abseiling, rock climbing, away weekends and two weeks annual Summer Camp are only a few of the fun things you'll be involved in if you join the cadets, plus of course learning more than a bit about Army life.

Just pop in to 84 Victoria Way, Charlton from 7.30pm to 9.30pm on a Tuesday or Thursday and have a chat with Jane Rowe who will give you all the details.

Don't worry, it's purely voluntary - you're not going to get signed up for anything but an interesting, fun time.

You can also contact Jane on her mobile, telephone number 0385 960352.

A GALA BENEFIT NIGHT FOR ROLLER SKATE CHAMPIONS

Following the story we published last month about the two youngsters from Abbey Wood, Dionne Covington and Michael Nash who are the reigning British Roller Dance Champions. Three of Thamesmead Towns' elected Directors, Gerry Bright, Albert Devereux and David Irons went to work to muster support for these two talented teenagers.

Within days of contacting companies who provide support services for the company's residents, they received many offers of financial help, in particular from D.Garwood & Sons Limited, S. Creamer Electrics Limited, S.Bird Associates, FMC Contracts Limited and Express Lifts Limited. The funds so far totalling over six hundred pounds will be further increased on the 16 th October when the three budding entrepreneurs Gerry, Albert and David stage a Gala Benefit Night of live Music and International Cabaret at the AbbeyMead Social Club.

The Chairman of Wettons Cleaning Services , Charlie Baker has undertaken to sponsor the evening's entertainment and Martin Feeney and his lovely lady Bridie have added their support by providing the Abbeymead Club as the venue for the evening.

The entertainment will be headed by the capricious adult comedian John Cassidy. The live music will be provided by Brian Spence and the rip roaring Debbie McKenna plus Suzie Q and a host of other guest artists including Thamesmeads' own Flanagan and Allan and the drunken antics of Freddie Flintham.

This benefit night in support of Dionne and Michael promises to be one of the best social gatherings ever witnessed locally. Tickets are limited and should be snapped up if you want to have a blinding night of laughter and entertainment and at the same time help Dionne and Michael to achieve their ambition to win the European Championship and later on the World Championship.

Tickets for this Gala Night are available at £5.00 per ticket and you can purchase them by contacting Albert Devereux on 0181 244 9323 or Gerry Bright on 0181 311 1946. Don't miss out by leaving your application too late.

Olympic success for Crossways Gym Club

All 32 London boroughs sent representatives to the preliminary rounds of the London Youth Olympic's ladies gymnastic event, held at Heathrow on July 1st.

Only eight borough teams progressed to the final which was held two weeks later at Crystal Palace – both Bexley and Greenwich were successful.

Standards were extremely high, but of course there had to be an eventual winner in the team competition, and that team was Bexley London Borough! The team from Greenwich finished a laudable seventh overall.

Thamesmead residents can feel particularly proud of the borough teams' successes, as no fewer than nine of the girls involved in the teams were from our very own Crossways Gym Club.

Tony Nell of the Crossways Club told the Thamesmead Times that he was very proud of the girls and the sheer hard work and effort that they had put in. "They all deserved their success – they're down here most evenings practising."

Most successful of the Thamesmead gymnasts was Tony's own daughter, Karen, who finished fourth overall in the individual four piece apparatus competition. Claire Aulsford, her Bexley team mate, finished in sixth position. Success for Greenwich came from Anneika Brown who was well placed in the two piece apparatus competition.

The successful girls were:
Karen Nell, Marie Gladwell, Claire Aulsford, Jenny Mendham, Louise Harryman, Stacey Ennis, Amy Jukes, Jo Marshall, Stephanie Lok, Anneika Brown





Scholarship success

Several of the girls have been able to attend the Crossways Gym Club thanks to Thamesmead's Youth Scholarship Scheme, which entitles the winner to a year's membership to a Thamesmead club, paid for by Thamesmead Town. The scheme encourages Thamesmead's young people to take an active part in the community and for these girls it could mean seeking medal success in the Sydney 2000 Olympics.

Congratulations to all at the Crossways Gym Club and we wish them all success in future competitions. For information on the gym club, contact Tony Nell on 0181 312 1190

Want to join a Youth Club

If you are interested in meeting new friends or getting involved in sports activities, you may find these details of local youth clubs helpful:

HAWKESMOOR YOUTH CLUB
BENTHAM ROAD
THAMESMEAD SE28
CONTACT:
ARTHUR BLACKMAN
0181 310 9754

HERRONSGATE YOUTH CENTRE
WHINCHAT ROAD
BROADWATERS
WEST THAMESMEAD SE28
CONTACT:
GRANT LAND

THAMESMEAD YOUTH CENTRE
COMMUNITY CAMPUS
YARNTON WAY
THAMESMEAD SOUTH
ERITH KENT
CONTACT:
MARTIN WYBORN
0181 310 0247

WATERFIELD COMMUNITY EDUCATION CENTRE
WATERFIELD CLOSE
THAMESMEAD SE 28
Tel: 0181 312 2121

GREENMEAD AFC

Hectic is the best word to describe our pre-season build up to the big kick off on 22nd September.

We started with a Dads v Players match on 4th August which was a great laugh for everybody. The match ended in a 7-7 draw with goals from Ricky Hardie, Tony Ray, Mark Savage, Nick Carlton, Matthew Keehne and Tony O'Brien (2) for the players and Glen Keehne (2), Dave Robson (2), Raymond Ray and guest player Tim Sullivan (2) for the dads. The U12 players won 3-2 on a penalty shoot out.

We would like to thank Thamesmead Youth Centre for the use of their new portable goals and Tim Sullivan for his help in setting up the match.

The £50 raised through match fees will be donated to the Youth Centre with our best wishes.

We have played five friendlies and are unbeaten with some very impressive performances from the team. Our goalkeeper Matthew Keehne is looking very confident along with our very steady defence of Justin Plant, Billy Watts, Darryl Kinsville, Darren O'Loughlin and Vice Captain Allen Gobbett.

The midfield men, Tony Ray, Andrew Johnson, Tony O'Brien, Sean Cross and Mark Savage have shown lots of quality in their passing with the front men, Captain, Ricky Hardie and Nick Carlton doing a great job up front.

The results in the matches so far have been 0 - 0 v Belvedere Sports, won 6 3 v Robins, won 6 -1 v Footscray Lions, won 9 - 3 v Birchwood and 0 - 0 v Russellers. We have controlled every match for long periods and fully deserve to be on our unbeaten run.

This is my fourth season with the team and I can honestly say that this is the strongest and most impressive I have seen them play.

For the record, our goal scorers so far this term are Nick Carlton (7), Tony O'Brien (4), Mark Savage (3) and Sean Cross, Darren O'Loughlin and Doug Robson with one each..

We welcome another new player to the squad, Doug Robson. His surname is appropriate as he is a very hard working player with great commitment. I am sure he will do a good job for us.

We would like to say a big THANK YOU to Julie Hickmott of Spiral Packs Limited and P. Holm of Batt Cables, Erith for their kind donations of £50 and £100 respectively. The money will be spent on new shin pads for the lads.

Finally, we have two spaces left in our squad so any league experienced players wishing to join us for a trial should ring me on 0181 311 3777 or the Assistant Manager Tony Day on 0181 310 9410 for details. Until next month, best wishes!

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THAMESMEAD Sport



Fishing in the South East

by John Perkins.

After the recent welcome rains, all Waters in the area are fishing well. Apart from the old favourites Bream and Roach, which are still showing well, we can know look forward to some other favourites with the onset of Autumn. If past Years patterns are repeated better specimens of Chub and Pike can be expected, one Pike recorded was a handsome beast weighing in at 17lbs. On the River Medway best methods for Chub, have proved to be the faithful Breadflake, Luncheon Meat, and the trusty Lobworm. Do not fish too light, and use a Size 10 Hook.

One notable catch I would like to mention on the Medway recently, from a swim at Barming which is always reputed to be poor, in a four hour session a Maidstone Memberr landed Seventeen Bream averaging 4lbs each.

Stillwaters are still fishing well, Mote Park in particular, showing well with Bream many over 7lbs, and some super Perch around the 2lb mark. This venue is as always good for its super Roach many being landed scaling over 2lbs.

Burham Reservoir showing well with good catches of Bream on Bread Roach on Tares. Do not forget to loose feed a little Hemp. Another super Autumn bait which should not be ignored is the Elderberry, ripening nicely now.

Those Anglers that travel into Kent and end up at the highly expensive Commercial Holes in the ground which are packed solid with the inevitable Carp, must I think soon become bored catching small fish every cast. If I am right and you need a challenge, which is what I believe is the real attraction of fishing, contact me and I will point you in the right direction. I can recommend many clubs with a wide variety of species to catch and from what I know of Club Fees, you can go as many times as you like for about a pound a Week, that must be good value in this Day and Age.

One sad note is of course the recent fatal accidents caused by touching Overhead Electric Cables. Always check overhead before you start fishing. In addition parents please be sure that its safe for your children, even in the local Farm Pond. Because its cheaper, the electricity companies, have always opted to go overhead, but it must be appreciated that many of these lines carry 11,000 Volts. Storms are another powerful source of electricity. If a storm rages, DO NOT CONTINUE FISHING, remember you have a super lightening conductor in your hand, and in addition your Brolly invariably has a metal shaft. Take care also not to shelter under high Trees, by far the safest place, is in your Car. In any event, IT IS BETTER TO BE WET, THAN DECEASED.

Angling Clubs if you have any events, you would like highlighted, or news of good catches, let me know. Further as I serve on many Committees, I am able to help with any Angling problems, either from individuals, or Clubs, please feel free to contact me on (01622) 202 686. If I do not know the answer, I know a man who does.

IT'S MORE THAN A POOL!

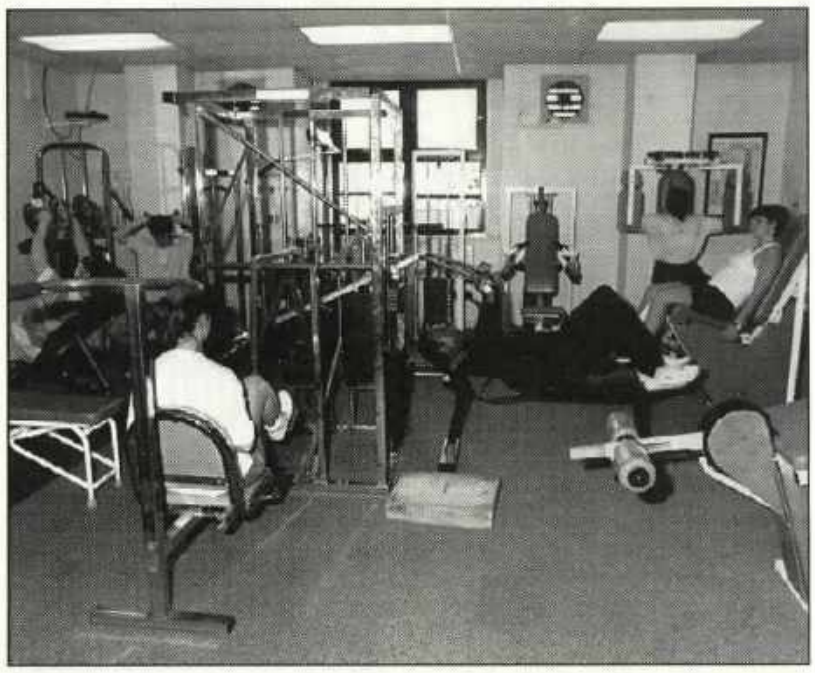
Thamesmead Times paid Thamesmere Leisure Centre a visit and we were surprised at how much was going on.

The centre's manager Blair Cottam told us what makes it such a special place: "I believe it's the friendly, relaxed atmosphere that the centre portrays. We try to make our visitors feel welcome as soon as they step through the door. So many establishments feel so unfriendly, whereas at Thamesmere Leisure Centre we know a lot of customers by name."

Our visit to the leisure centre took place on a sunny afternoon, not the time you would expect to see many exerting themselves. We were wrong, there was a constant circuit of keen exercisers moving round the fitness suite.

He explained why people come to Thamesmere, "We cater for all the family. Swimming sessions for all ages and abilities, Keep Fit Classes, a fitness suite, creche, sauna, sunbeds, toddlers play sessions and much more. I suggest you keep your eyes on the Thamesmead Times, we will be advertising in every issue, detailing forthcoming events and promotions at Thamesmere Leisure Centre."

There is a full size pool and a mini pool for the younger water babies. A huge slide stretches the length of the larger pool, I can only imagine the shouts of laughter as young and not so young slide and swoop their way down into the water. The leisure centre is about to experience some personnel changes, the present manager, Blair Cottam is moving to Woolwich's Waterfront, bye bye and good luck Blair! The new manager is Peter Simons, hello and welcome to Thamesmead Peter!





HAPPY DAYS AT PARK VIEW

What a difference a season makes! Only nine months ago Park View was playing host to a struggling Erith ~ Belvedere side whose points tally was never to reach double figures, and a Dartford team struggling to fight their way back up, in the lower depths of the pyramid.

The 1996/97 season has developed very differently, and suddenly the historic old ground has a fresh air of excitement about it. The venue is now playing host to two Southern league teams, thanks to Dartford's promotion last season, making it the only ground to do so. Both are faring very well with 'Darts' attendance's regularly hitting the 400 mark.

The landlords' solid start will have come as the biggest surprise. A win, two draws and an F.A. Cup victory, plus the fantastic signing of ex Welling striker Liburd Henry has given newly appointed manager Mick Ackland reason to feel very positive about the clubs future. Certainly the 'Deres' are playing with more ambition than last term, and looking rather dangerous with it.

Dartford have taken to the higher league like a duck to water, and look as though they could be amongst the challengers at their first attempt. Their goal is to get back to the peak of the non-league ladder, and they are making a very good job of it. They have played good, attacking footba~ in every one of their home games this season and thoroughly deserve their 10 points out of 12. With an average attendance of over 350 the atmosphere just adds to the 'Darts' charm.

If you are a local football fan, come and attend a game at Park View to see either Erith or Dartford, it could well be a season to remember.

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